

Evan Dower, Staff Software Engineer

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Location: Remote/Seattle, WA, USA

Visa Status: Seeking sponsorship for relocation to Australia or New Zealand

Professional Summary

- Rapidly delivers results even in new domains due to quickly gaining in-depth knowledge
- Delivers incrementally, with a focus on using data to determine whether further investment makes business sense
- Supports team cohesion & productivity by supporting teammates' growth

Core Competencies

Frontend & Platform Engineering: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Module Federation, Webpack, Micro-frontends, Performance Optimization

Backend & Infrastructure: Java, Node.js, Spring, Distributed Systems, API Design, CI/CD

Data & Analytics: Spark (Scala), Data Pipeline Optimization, A/B Testing, Performance Metrics

Leadership & Collaboration: Technical Mentorship, Cross-functional Coordination, Architecture Design, Code Review

Experience

Indeed, Seattle, WA

At Indeed, I evolved from individual contributor to engineering manager and back to senior IC, gaining valuable leadership experience while deepening my technical expertise. After successfully managing a 6-person engineering team for two years, I made the strategic decision to return to hands-on technical work, driven by the personal satisfaction I derive from direct problem-solving, my desire to maximize impact through technical contribution, and my eagerness to learn new domains. This transition allowed me to pivot into frontend platform engineering, where I could apply my leadership skills while building critical infrastructure used across the entire organization.

Staff Software Engineer (Frontend Platforms) - April 2019 to present

Platform Development & Architecture:

- modernized the global navigation service toolchain (Cypress 9 to 15, Node 22/24, ESLint 9, TypeScript 5.9, and a full migration of smoke tests to Playwright), clearing years of accumulated infrastructure debt
- built & productionized micro-frontend framework, decoupling hundreds of content provider teams & dozens of consuming webapp teams to enable rapid, independent iteration
- owned global header deployed across all Indeed pages & webapps while expanding coverage, iterating on content, and migrating to Indeed's new design system
- designed & implemented JavaScript dependency sharing solution using webpack module federation, reducing page weight by eliminating duplicate downloads across decoupled components
- led exploration/validation of webpack module federation as UI decoupling mechanism, establishing expertise as one of Indeed's few subject matter experts for this technology
- developed shared scope and libraries that abstract complex module federation details from customers
- delivered platform for distributing non-UI capabilities (e.g. observability, cookie compliance, etc.) across all Indeed products

Performance & Optimization:

- designed and shipped a server-side rendering worker pool for the global navigation and job seeker web services, increasing the share of search-results page users experiencing good site speed by 18%, contributing a 4% improvement to the organization's site-speed objective, and cutting the job seeker web service's running instances by 35% (~\$115K projected annual savings); senior leadership called it a "RIDICULOUS improvement" and a peer called it "one of the biggest single improvements to sitespeed we've had to date"
- root-caused head-of-line blocking to main-thread JSON parsing and replaced it with buffer-based stream parsing that eliminated quadratic string concatenation; added trace propagation and per-variant observability, and resolved production connection-reset errors
- contributed parallel S3 uploads to the company-wide shared CI templates, cutting merge-request pipeline time from ~11.5 to ~1.5 minutes and making the speedup available to every engineering team, and published an engineering blog post on the

change

- optimized performance impact & safety of global navigation header, reducing initial bundle size by 48%, improving isolation, and enabling dependency sharing via module federation
- delivered shared-deps event loop optimization achieving 0.68% overall worldwide site speed improvement, resulting in 0.34% increase in Homepage Job Clicks and 0.31% increase in Total Job Applications
- reduced GNAV payload size by 84% to enhance Indeed Mobile performance
- collaborated with Marketing to remove Google DCM tag from mobile search, achieving 1-3% site speed improvements
- authored comprehensive 2024 Site Speed Opportunities analysis that formed the site speed roadmap for Job Seeker products
- enhanced performance of data analysis pipeline by >10x while simultaneously improving correctness

Technical Leadership & Problem Solving:

- architected and led design system v7 dual-building infrastructure enabling safe A/B testing across multiple product surfaces, coordinating cross-org sequencing and risk management that delivered seamless rollout of critical priority-1 cross-organizational upgrade; root-caused conflicting micro-frontend providers overriding design tokens, built automated style resolution, and limited the measured site-speed impact to ~2% versus a projected 30% risk
- delivered 8% Homepage performance improvement through GraphQL bundle optimization and dependency upgrades, achieving VP-level recognition and enabling neutral A/B impact that “singlehandedly saved this priority-1 cross-organizational initiative”
- led React 18 and design system v6 upgrade initiative across 6 critical Job Seeker Frontend surfaces, delivering green pipelines and enabling Phase 2 rollout
- collaborated with PMs and Design to set browser support policy for jobseeker product area, analyzing cost/benefit trade-offs and creating enforceable guidelines to reduce technical debt
- owned technical execution of pnpm migration for mobile platform to facilitate centralization within mono-repo after previous rollback
- drove design system v7 compliance across all Job Seeker frontend platform surfaces, collaborating cross-functionally with Design System team to implement dark mode support through IndeedThemeProvider
- facilitated smooth adoption of module federation across Indeed by building libraries that act as guard-rails around core features with sharp edges, including [fixing bugs in webpack itself](#)
- diagnosed and resolved employer frontend platform race condition issue by upgrading render service from Preact to React 16, simplifying development experience
- prevented production incidents by identifying nuanced dependency issues between core systems
- enhanced automated testing and streamlined release processes to achieve full push-on-green CI/CD
- orchestrated failure modes brainstorming and improved deployment processes including multi-branch builds and auto-ticket management
- rapidly investigated & resolved high severity production issues
- served as primary owner of critical index builders supporting Job Search organisation SLOs, resolving 2 major incidents with Data Platform coordination

Cross-Organizational Impact:

- pioneered AI-driven developer productivity through TEA (Talent Enablement Automation), evolving a hackathon project into a production CLI for AI-assisted performance evaluations, built on daily work summaries and peer feedback, and adopted across software engineering, technical delivery, data science, and product science roles
- served as primary technical lead for global navigation and micro-frontend integration questions from identity, authentication, employer, international, and mobile teams, including architectural guidance on server-side rendering for LLM crawlers
- influenced team strategy through participation in 2025H1 planning, providing effort estimates and strategic direction for key initiatives
- identified and scoped platform improvement opportunities including sitespeed observability and beachball migration consolidation
- provided technical enablement for messaging team’s “new message” feature implementation in global navigation
- allocated 25% time to on-call duties and platform maintenance, responding to alerts and support requests as subject matter expert
- represented UI Platform Web US in cross-team tech leads sync for Job-Seeker Journey organisation (6-12 teams), expanding influence beyond immediate team
- served as main point-of-contact for VM2 security vulnerability, coordinating resolution across teams and orchestrating deprecation
- delivered architectural guidance to multiple teams including JSMA on native navigation and Viewjob team on re-use initiatives
- championed React 18 and design system v6 rollouts across Indeed, advocating for upgrades and identifying implementation paths
- designed & planned initiative to add page weight observability to all Indeed products

Mentorship & Community:

- recognized as “at the forefront of AI adoption among Indeed engineers”: mentored engineers as an AI Champion on AI tooling workflows, MCP server configuration, and prompt engineering, and published an engineering blog post on getting AI to write in your own voice
- served as primary support expert for TEA, resolving 30+ support threads across 7+ teams during a review cycle, and published documentation and an engineering blog post enabling self-service onboarding
- contributed to inclusive culture through neurodiversity and caregiver employee resource groups
- mentored engineers across teams on flame-graph analysis, performance triage, and debugging techniques, teaching investigative skills that accelerated problem-solving and upskilled data-driven investigative abilities organization-wide
- provided technical mentorship and stakeholder management coaching to team members, including formal mentorship relationship with junior engineer transitioning to software engineering role
- mentored teammates and engineers across the company, helping them break work into incremental deliverables while prioritising early risk-discovery & risk-reduction
- coached Sr. Cloud Solutions Engineer via Mentor Connect on defining and spreading best practices across the company
- guided 100+ external contributors to Global Nav platform through code reviews and technical direction

Tech Stack: JavaScript, TypeScript, NodeJS, React, Emotion, Webpack, Module Federation, Cypress, Playwright, Java, Spark (Scala), DataDog, Terraform

Software Engineer / Technical Delivery Manager (SMB Hiring) - July 2017 to March 2019

- managed performance & development of 6 software engineers to help them reach their potential
- secured team buy-in to initiate development processes and promote best practices ensuring team efficiency
- coordinated with cross-functional team members, including 1 designer, 1 quality assurance engineer, 1 data scientist, & 2 product managers
- collaborated with other teams to achieve mutual business goals
- partnered with other teams to form cross-organisation plans
- directed business & technical strategy of the team
- contributed to design reviews throughout the company
- led team to achieve quarterly goals including >3% of jobs with context-specific questions and 116 new question types (surpassing goal of 100)
- increased jobs with screener questions in Italy, Spain & France by 68% (from 44% to 74%) while maintaining >60% acceptance rate
- delivered high utility question identification, increasing employer positive response rate by 8%
- built automation infrastructure for dev-free question creation, including proctor test creation and automated verification screenshots
- coordinated event handling & prevention across SMB Hiring teams, providing technical leadership during production issues

Senior Software Engineer / Tech Lead (SMB Hiring) - January 2017 to June 2017

- guide the technical direction of the team
- mentor 4 software engineers to help them grow their technical skills
- collaborate with other teams to help them & us achieve business goals
- delivered 6 new question types, increasing total by 50%, including innovative “firsts”: localized education (first locale-dependent question), nursing degree (first vertical-specific question), and shift availability (first multi-select question)
- maintained service reliability with over 5 9’s uptime on almost 1.5B calls

Software Engineer (SMB Hiring) - August 2015 to December 2016

Leadership:

- Worked with product management to collaboratively define data-driven quarterly goals.
- Led a team of 4 engineers to track & meet those goals.
- Participated constructively in design reviews

Individual Contributions:

- Demonstrated proof-of-concept for increasing job requirement suggestion acceptance rate by 15%. *A/B testing*
- Achieved ~1.3 million question suggestions accepted in Q4 2016 with order-of-magnitude improvement quarter-over-quarter
- Increased overall suggested question acceptance rate from 25% to 43% and outside-US acceptance rate from 18% to 32%
- Designed & implemented client-focused data-driven API to help decouple client & service changes. *Java, Spring, Jackson,*

Protobuf

- Introduced numerous best-practices and tools to reduce coding errors, and guided teams across the company in their use. *Immutable, Jackson, Fongo, Checkstyle, Spring-Data-MongoDB, AssertJ*
- Created abstraction between persistence layer and API, introducing Spring Data to support key team initiatives
- Implemented Pig script to filter out underperforming suggestions, achieving ~15% suggestion acceptance improvement for specific job titles
- Improved location service algorithm and JUnit parameter support as Indeed-wide infrastructure contributions
- Dug deep into other teams' code in order to address production issues as well as internal productivity issues. *Python, Django, Java*

Amazon, Seattle, WA

During my decade at Amazon, I evolved into a full-stack developer with expertise in distributed systems, developer productivity tools, and large-scale infrastructure. I demonstrated technical leadership through mentoring and delivering systems that served thousands of developers and saved millions in operational costs.

Software Development Engineer (Developer Productivity Tools) - December 2006 to July 2015

Key Achievements:

- **Cost Optimization:** Improved deployment scheduling algorithm from $O(n^3)$ to $O(n^2)$, enabling Amazon to scale deployment capacity for Q4 loads and potentially saving millions of dollars
- **Infrastructure Ownership:** Led implementation of highly available revision control supporting >300k Git repositories for >10k developers
- **Process Automation:** Designed and delivered company-wide continuous deployment system, modelling and automating ~40k release processes
- **Vendor Cost Reduction:** Owned internal revision control systems with monitoring, throttling, and hot standby capabilities, enabling Amazon to terminate Perforce support contract and save ~\$1M annually
- **Developer Tools:** Built internal code browser with innovative features including always-on blame, visual DAGs, and pull-requests, serving >10k users company-wide

Tech Stack: Java, Ruby on Rails, Python, Git, Oracle, DynamoDB, AngularJS, Perl

Software Development Engineer (Ordering) - March 2005 to December 2006

- Owned marketplace seller order management system used by all Amazon sellers (backend services and web frontends)
- Managed reporting and optimization of stuck/delayed order metrics, coordinating cross-team resolution of root causes

Education

University of Washington, Seattle
Bachelor of Science (B.S.), Computer Science
2001 - 2005